

James Evans

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING LEADER

Melbourne, Australia | hello@jamesevans.au | <https://jamesevans.au>

SUMMARY

I lead engineering teams and still ship code. Over 25 years I have grown from software engineer to General Manager level, currently running the engineering behind Australia Post's Point of Sale across around 4,000 stores. I care about delivery, reliability and the people doing the work; I ran a 150-engineer graduate program and have raised engineering standards everywhere I have led. Lately I have brought AI tooling (Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, GitHub Copilot) into how my teams work, and I help other businesses do the same.

SKILLS

AI tooling: Claude, Claude Cwork, M365 Copilot, GitHub Copilot · C# / .NET · TypeScript · JavaScript: React, Vue, Angular · PHP / Laravel · APIs and microservices · SQL: MySQL, Oracle · CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins, GitLab · Azure, AWS and GCP · Docker

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Manager, Point of Sale

[Australia Post](#) | [Melbourne](#) | [Nov 2023 to Present](#)

I lead the engineering team behind Australia Post's Point of Sale system across the retail network of around 4,000 stores. My focus is delivery, team leadership and reliability for a system that has to work every day, in every store. I also champion AI tooling across the team, using Microsoft 365 Copilot and GitHub Copilot to lift how we work.

- Own engineering delivery for the POS platform used across ~4,000 retail outlets.
- Lead and grow the engineering team, balancing hands-on technical direction with people leadership.
- Introduced AI developer tooling (GitHub Copilot, M365 Copilot) to speed delivery and cut busywork.
- Drive delivery cadence and reliability for a business-critical, high-availability retail system.

Chapter Lead Principal (General Manager)

[Telstra](#) | [Melbourne](#) | [Aug 2022 to Nov 2023](#)

Led the Employee Experience Engineers across three chapters (30 staff), partnering closely with Product Owners, orchestrating resourcing, and running OPEX vs CAPEX analysis and forecasting, while staying hands-on in code.

- Ran Telstra's Software Engineering Graduate Program for 150 engineers across Australia and India, from interview through onboarding and training.
- Implemented a global resourcing strategy that lifted offshore exposure 15% and reduced costs by ~\$200k p.a.
- Negotiated resource-partner agreements for a 9% rate reduction; delivered 5% year-on-year budget reductions.
- Raised engineering standards through CI/CD patterns, metrics, peer programming and code review.

Engineering Chapter Lead

[Telstra](#) | [Melbourne](#) | [Aug 2019 to Aug 2022](#)

A pioneering Chapter Lead during Telstra's move to Scaled Agile, building and running a chapter of 20 engineers responsible for Telstra's Employee Tools: email, M365, device management, collaboration apps and HR systems.

- Transformed the Employee Tools team into an Agile-at-scale model across software and hardware.
- Designed a learning framework for new engineers that drew onboarding demand from other business units.
- Increased permanent staff ratio by 30% and strengthened the on-call roster for critical systems.

Senior Software Engineer

[Telstra](#) | [Melbourne](#) | [Dec 2013 to Aug 2019](#)

Designed, built and maintained complex software across the Workplace Technology teams, mentored junior engineers, and architected secure solutions to hard problems.

- Built a project tracking and reporting app (PHP, Angular, MySQL on AWS) with 300+ daily users, saving 1 to 2 hours per person per week.
- Led a front-end automation solution migrating 200,000 customers between CRMs on a 50-machine OpenSpan robot fleet running 24/7, saving over \$500k in manual effort.
- Architected a head-office reception display showing live floor and desk availability from network traffic.

Application Development Manager

[Telstra](#) | [Melbourne](#) | [Jun 2012 to Dec 2013](#)

Led a configuration team on the NICE product suite, transitioned development from vendor to a new in-house team, and introduced a successful Agile approach with fortnightly production releases.

Senior Application Consultant

[NICE Systems](#) | [Melbourne](#) | [Apr 2011 to Jun 2012](#)

Sole representative for the Australasian region, managing customer support expectations and meeting SLAs for NICE's performance-management software suite.

EARLIER CAREER

2009 to 2011 to Application Support, Australian Air Express, Melbourne

2008 to 2009 to Application Support, Merced Systems, London

2007 to 2008 to Quality Assurance, SEGA Europe, London

2005 to 2007 to Business Analyst, Fonterra, New Zealand

2002 to 2005 to Support Analyst, Fonterra, New Zealand

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Information Systems

University of Waikato, New Zealand | 1999 to 2002